

Lecture 5: Ethics for AI and Robotics

COMP3018/COMP5018: Human-Robot Interaction

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Introduction

- Today's Topics

- 1- Ethics for AI and Robotics

- Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of today's lecture you will be able to:

- 1- Describe the ethical challenges raised by the use of technology

- 2- Describe the approaches through which we can consider ethics in AI

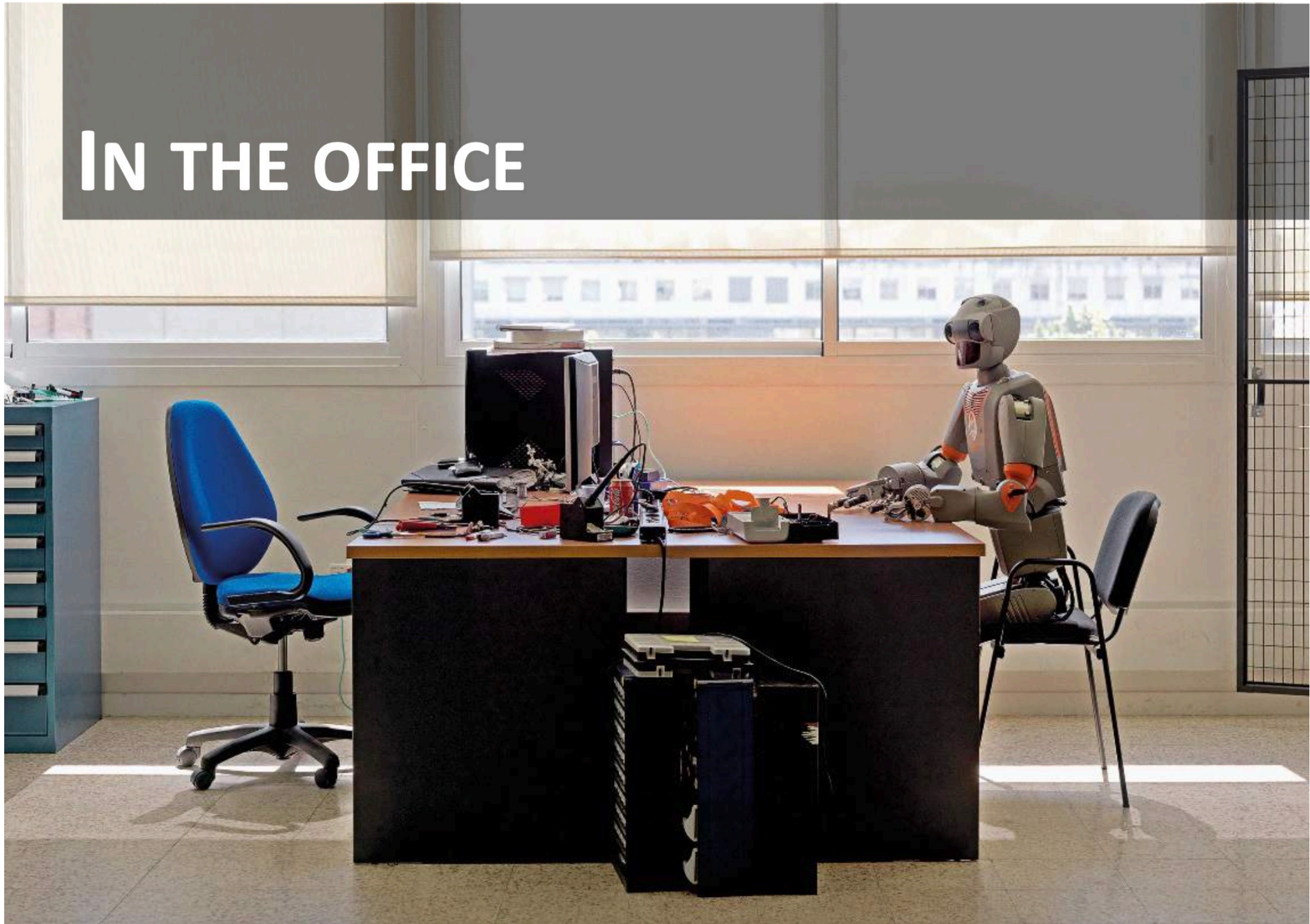
Technology and AI Nowadays ...

AI: IN YOUR POCKET



Technology and AI Nowadays ...

IN THE OFFICE

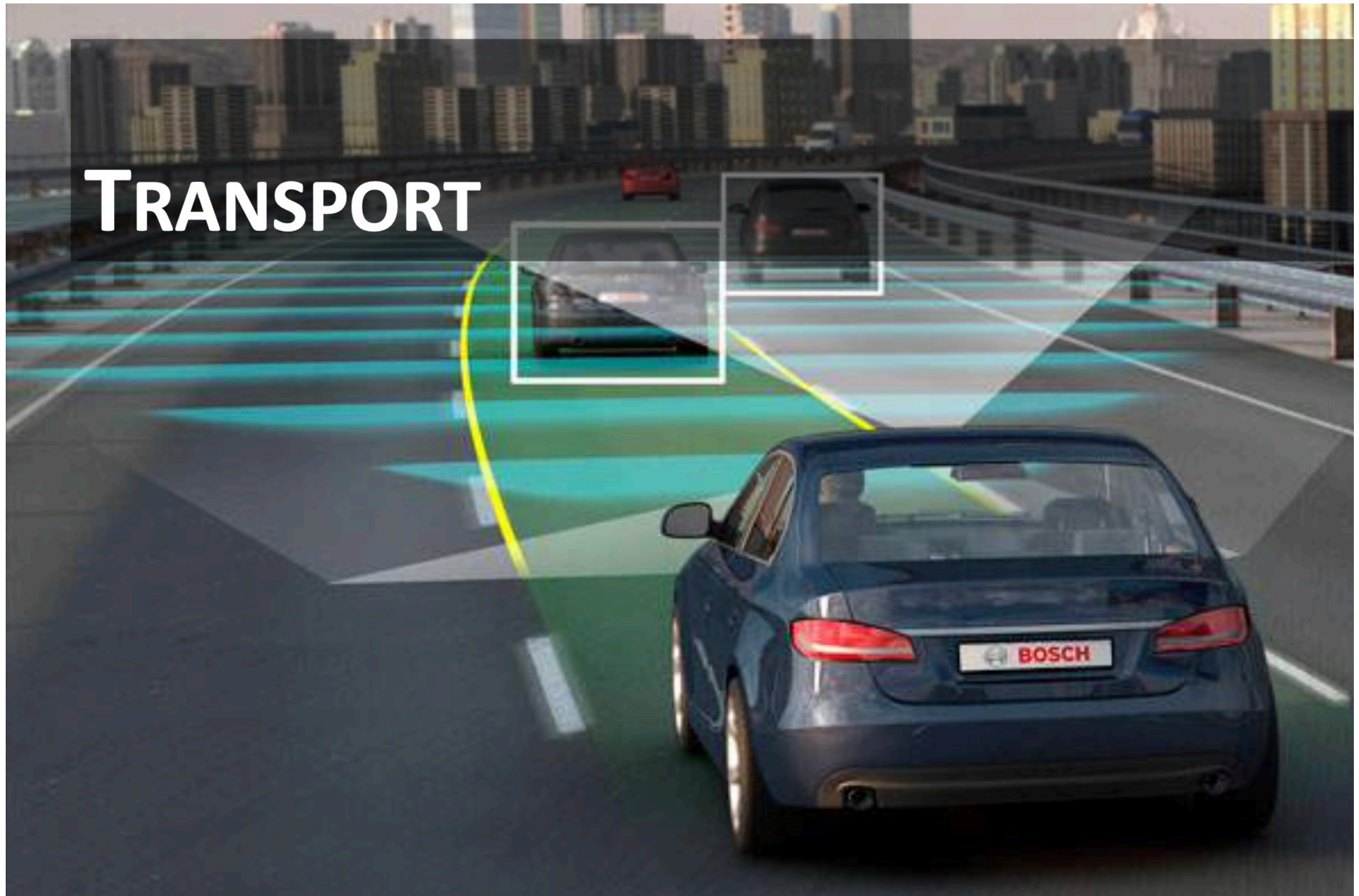


Technology and AI Nowadays ...

FINANCE



Technology and AI Nowadays ...



Technology and AI Nowadays ...

HEALTH CARE



Technology and AI Nowadays ...

MILITARY APPLICATIONS

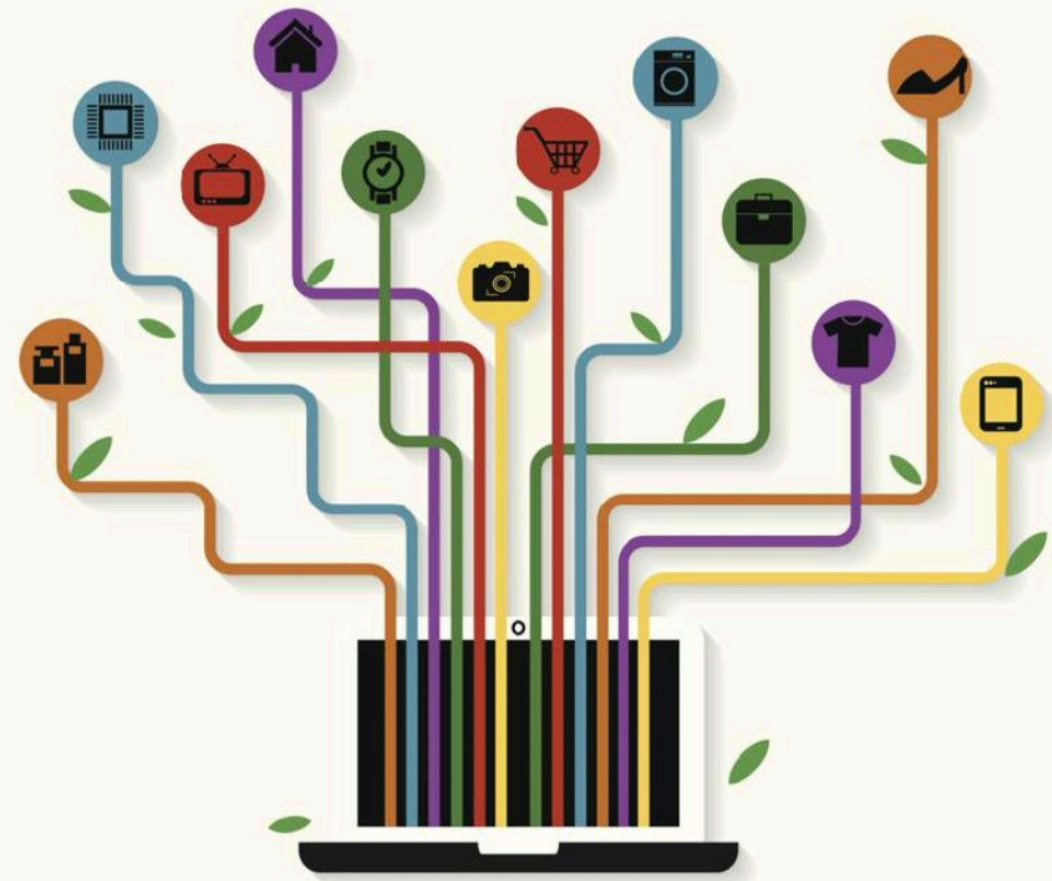


Technology and AI Nowadays ...

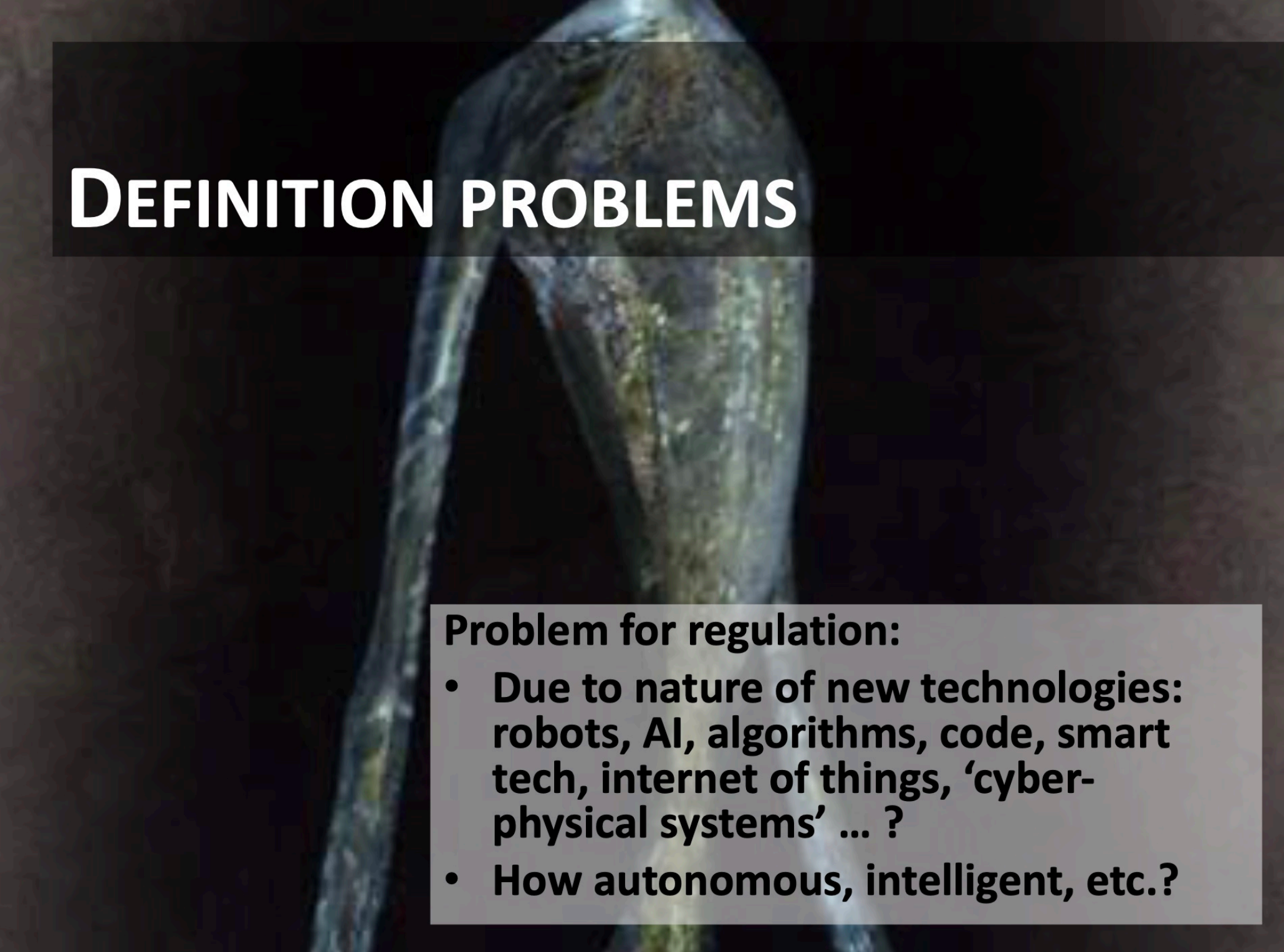
DATA



ALL THINGS - EVERYWHERE



Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology



DEFINITION PROBLEMS

Problem for regulation:

- Due to nature of new technologies: robots, AI, algorithms, code, smart tech, internet of things, 'cyber-physical systems' ... ?
- How autonomous, intelligent, etc.?

Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology



- The AI records what you do and transfers data... to whom? Company? Third Party?
- What if your robot gets hacked?

Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology

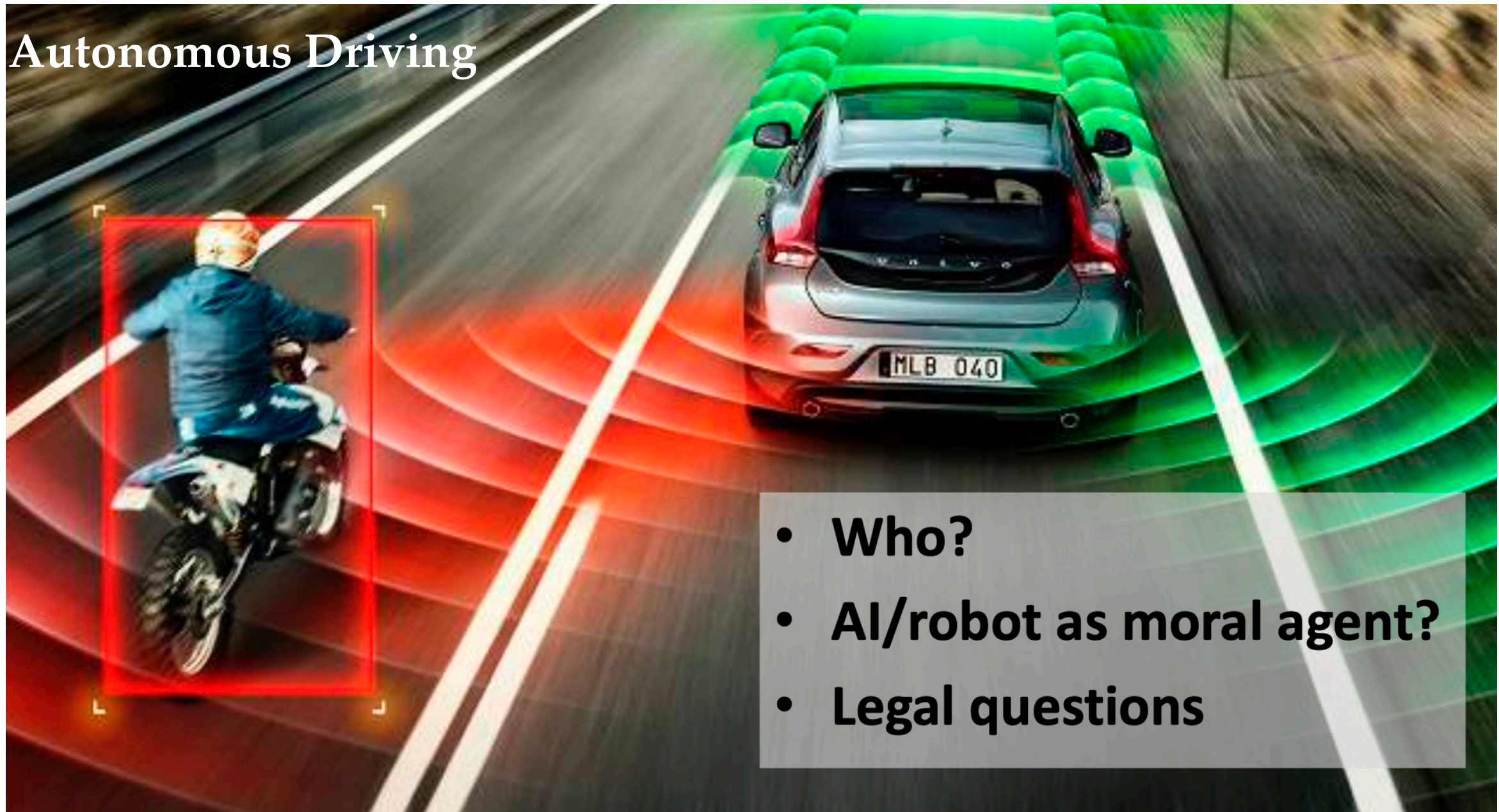


REPLACEMENT, AUTONOMY, LOSS OF AGENCY?

- Robot/AI - human teams
- Degrees of autonomy
- Distributed agency

Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology

Autonomous Driving



- Who?
- AI/robot as moral agent?
- Legal questions

Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology

- Moral and Legal Responsibility

Examples

- An autonomous car drives into a group of children
- AI causes crashes in financial markets
- Machines harm workers in a factory
- Care robot gives the wrong medication
- Killer robot kills civilian
- A child gets too attached to an educational robot

Some Issues Raised due to the Use of Technology

Examples

- **An autonomous car drives into a group of children**

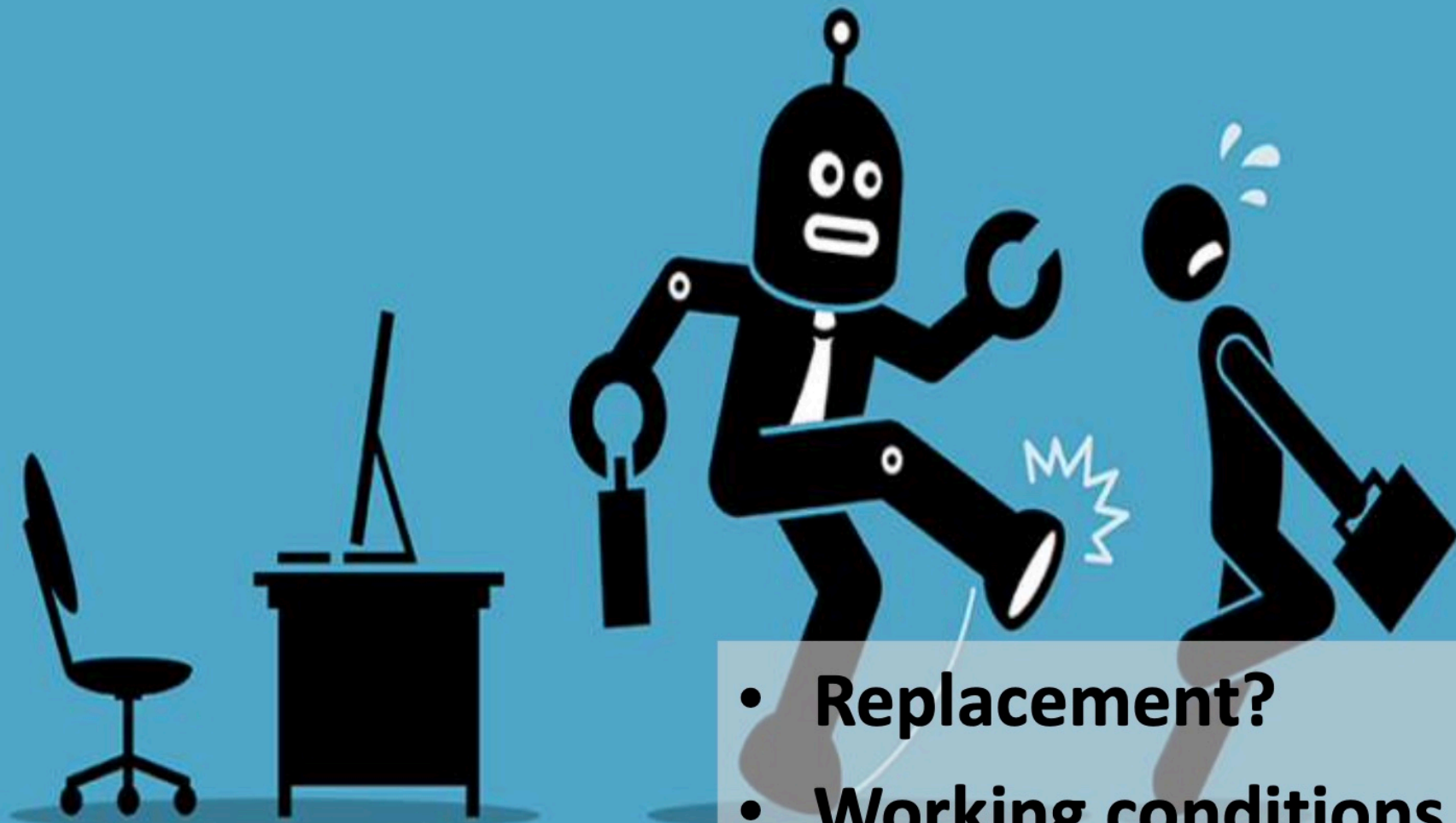
Action: Classification (Society of Automotive Engineers - SAE) / 6 levels of self-driving:

- **Level 0**: monitoring, warnings
- **Level 1**: adaptive cruise control, automated parking
- **Level 2**: automated driving, but the driver must be alert and be able to take over any time
- ...
- **Level 5**: no human intervention is needed

But still, not enough, more is needed

Societal Implications of AI

THE FUTURE OF WORK



- Replacement?
- Working conditions and experience of work?

Societal Implications of AI



Societal Implications of AI

BIASED ALGORITHMS

- Problem in machine learning: AI trains on dataset that may contain a bias (e.g. favors young white men)
- Problem of algorithm or society, or both? How to deal with this?
- Right non-discrimination

Societal Implications of AI

BIASED ALGORITHMS

- **Is bias avoidable? No, but we can explicitly discuss, analyze, and intervene (kind of bias, degree of bias)**

Societal Implications of AI

NON-TRANSPARENT ALGORITHMS

- Problem with new approaches to AI: Decision AI/algorithm black box, I am affected by its decision but do not know how it came to its decision
- Right to be informed, “Right to Explanation of Automated Decision Making” (Wachter et al. 2017) but is that possible?

AI - Ethics

Regulations are needed, legal frameworks are needed, ...

Ethics

- Ethics is a branch of philosophy that deals with moral principles and values that guide human behavior. Ethics is concerned with what is right and wrong, good and bad, and what ought to be done or avoided. **In the context of AI and robotics**, ethics refers to the principles and values that should guide the development, deployment, and use of these technologies.
- **Meta-Ethics**
 - Studying where our ethics come from
 - Are they derived from human nature, society, religion, cultural norms, or something universal and objective?
- **Normative Ethics**
 - Generating moral standards for right vs. wrong
 - The consequences of our behaviors on others
- **Applied Ethics**
 - Examining specific controversial issues (nuclear war, animal rights)

Ethics

Some examples of scientific research in which ethics play a large role:

- Stem cell research
- Cloning/genetically modified food
- Nuclear technology
- Animal rights
- Medical trials
- Disease research
- New technologies have unintended negative side effects
- Scientists and engineers must think about:
 - how they should act on the job
 - what projects should or should not be done
 - and how they should be handled

Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches

ETHICS: APPROACH

- **Bottom up**
- **Pro-active**

Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches

- Bottom-up approach



Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches



Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches

ETHICS: HOW NOT TO DO IT



Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches

- Ensure that automation designs and deployments do not create ethical hazards for individuals and society.

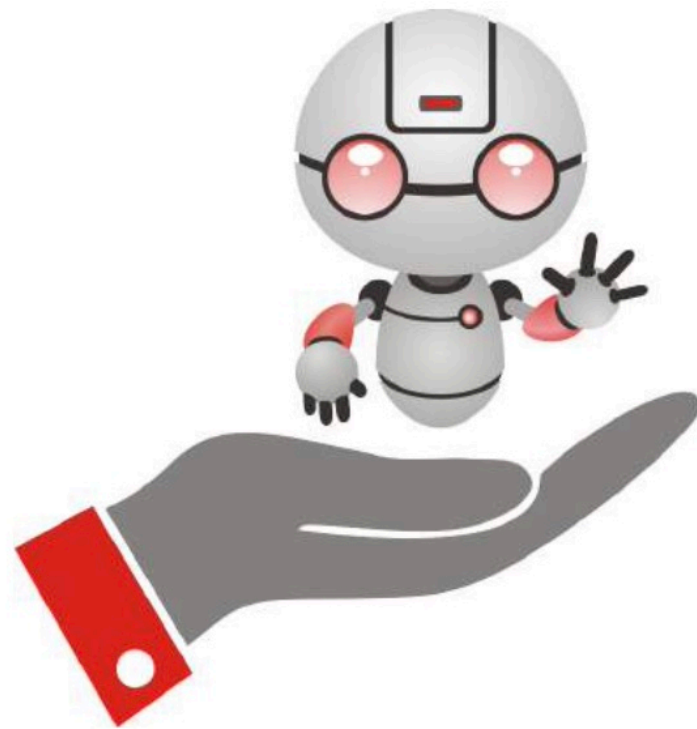


ETHICS: PRO-ACTIVE IN RESEARCH AND INNOVATION

- Regulation: needed, but always too late?
- Work also through standards, see IEEE
- Certification

Considering Ethics in AI: Approaches

ALSO NON-GOVERNMENTAL ACTORS!



RESPONSIBLE
ROBOTICS

Accountable Innovation for the Humans Behind the Robots

Ethics in AI



Policy needed

**Everyone affected, need for vision and policy
NOW**

Summary

- Today we discussed

1- Ethics for AI and Robotics

- Next week

1- We will discuss a different topic; i.e., Models for Human-Robot Collaboration